eunomia

April 2026

Sarah Edwards

Best-In-Class Plastic Packaging Tool

Natural Economy

Circular Economy

Low Carbon Economy

Certified B Corporation

When planning source reduction pathways, benchmarking is required

Producers will submit Individual Source Reduction Plans, justifying how far they will implement each of the five 'pillars'

Reuse - Refill

01

Reuse / refill reduces how often new packaging needs to be produced by keeping it in circulation longer.

Elimination

02

Removing a plastic component without replacing that component with a non-plastic alternative.

Material Switching Away from Plastic

03

Substituting plastic material for non-plastic materials (e.g., paper, fiber, glass, metal)

Rightsizing, Lightweighting, Concentrate, Bulk Format

04

- **Right-sizing:** Optimizing the size and dimensions of packaging.
- **Lightweighting:** Reducing the weight of packaging components while maintaining performance
- **Concentration:** Reformulating the product to use smaller quantities.
- **Bulk format:** Commercial reusable containers or large packaging for refill

Post-Consumer Recycled (PCR)

05

Switching from virgin material to post-consumer recycled content.

CAA cannot current compare these plans across producers (especially elimination and lightweighting, two of the key strategies)

Current State and Problem:

Ambitious targets, limited data and clarity on what's achievable

1. **Source reduction target dates start in 2027 and are highly ambitious**
   CAA currently has no visibility on how far plastic can be source reduced across brands, formats and strategies

2. **Individual producer source reduction reporting will provide insights, but assumptions may not be reliable**
   Data provided by brands will provide insights on what brands think is, but this won't necessarily reflect actual technical potential

3. **Reported data is not granular enough to identify what is possible**
   Packaging POM data is reported at the level of CMCs, whereas source reduction is driven by packaging formats and the products contained

4. **Producers don't always know what best-in-class looks like**
   Most brands state that their packaging is best-in-class or has been optimized, but lack the data to justify this

5. **Best practice format benchmarks will support change**
   CAA needs a mechanism to drive best practice in source reduction and provide guidance to brands, and link this to fee eco-modulation

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The Solution:

A data-driven tool to identify high-potential areas for lightweighting and elimination

Our Solution:
Best-in-Class Plastic Packaging Tool

A database of plastic weight and component use across 20-30 key products showing best-in-class, median and worst-in-class performance

Sense-Checking ISRPs
CAA can ensure that brands' claims line up with best-in-class seen elsewhere

Practical Guidance for Brands
Brands can be directed to optimized packaging formats for different applications

Using Data to Benchmark and Drive Progress Towards Targets
Ultimately this information can be used to eco-modulate fees

What this is not?

- A design for recyclability tool, although the two could be linked into on in the future
- A static tool; it can grow and evolve based on producer data and updated best practice designs

Our approach ensures data-based outcomes and clear alignment on goals

Overarching Approach to CAA's
Best-In-Class Plastic Packaging Tool

01	02	03	04	05	06
		touch	touch		
Project kick-off	Identify key product formats and regions	Pack sourcing	Structured data capture	Key opportunity summary	Action Finder Tool development

Task led by Eunomia

touch Task led by Touch

Overarching Approach (1/2)

Overarching Approach to CAA's
Best-In-Class Plastic Packaging Tool

Task 01 — Project Kick-off

Kick-off call with key CAA stakeholders to:
- Clarify scope of work and ways of working
- Review data requests

Output

A summary of:
- Timelines
- Deliverables
- Expected data requests

Task 02 — Identify key product formats and regions

Collaborate with CAA to identify markets and products to be studied:
- Use data collected through Needs Assessment to identify product types contributing most to plastic tons and components; supplement this with data collected so far by CAA
- Choose top 20-30 product types and 5 study markets

Output

Agreement on:
1. 15 critical products
2. Three chosen study markets in addition to USA and UK

Task 03 — Pack Sourcing (touch)

- Identify and collect 5 best-in-class and 2 worst-in-class examples of each format in the UK using Touch's industry expertise
- Use this data to inform pack purchasing of across other markets (including US)

Output

For each market, a database of all collected products and their price.

Task 04 — Structured data capture (touch)

Analyze packs for: component count and weight, pack weight, weight/product, materials, headroom/void space, design features enabling lightweighting.

Output

Database of 20-30 SKUs across 5 markets.

Overarching Approach (2/2)

Overarching Approach to CAA's
Best-In-Class Packaging Tool

Task 05

Key opportunities

Combine best-in-class data with consumption analyses to identify greatest opportunities for source reduction

Output

List of products that show the greatest potential for weight/components reduction

Task 06

Action Finder Tool

Turn the best-in-class database into a tool that can be used by CAA to help guide producers in finding plastic savings across lightweighting, elimination of components etc.

Output

Best-In-Class Action Finder Tool

Task 07a (future)

Expansion

- Build out number of formats
- Adapt into online tool, accessible by producers
- Link to fees and eco-modulation

Output

Source Reduction Levers Online Producer Tool

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Plastic Packaging Best-In-Class Excel Tool

	Typical Sizes	Median			Worst-In-Class			Best-In-Class		
		Plastic Weight	Plastic/ Product	Separable Pl. Components	Plastic Weight	Plastic/ Product	Separable Pl. Components	Plastic Weight	Plastic/ Product	Separable Pl. Components
Detergent	42oz	.22 lb	.52	1. Bottle 2. Pump 3. Seal 4. Lid	.41 lb	.98	1. Bottle 2. Label 3. Seal 4. Lid 5. Pump 6. Ball	.16 lb	.38	1. Bottle 2. Lid
	92oz	.33 lb	.35		.72 lb	.78		.21 lb	.23	
	138oz	.41 lb	.30		.81 lb	.59		.38 lb	.27	
Savory Snack (Low Barrier)	6oz	.01 lb	.14	1. Flexible bag	.05 lb	.66	1. Bottle 2. Lid	.005 lb	.09	1. Flexible bag
	16oz	.02 lb	.11		.08 lb	.48		.01 lb	.07	
	32oz	.03 lb	.08		.12 lb	.38		.02 lb	.05	

Identify product categories with highest potential for source reduction

Provide evidence to brands on moving to best-in-class

...

Top 20-30* most plastic-intense product categories

**Our analysis as part of the Needs Assessment suggests 19 product categories are responsible for 90% of consumer plastic tons and 94% of components; there will be some important variations within these product categories, so we have used 20-30 as a guide range*

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Eunomia x Touch Design:

Policy Expertise meets Packaging Innovation

Experts in policy and sustainability

Experts in pack design and innovation

Packaging legislation is complex, and so is consumer-centric, branded pack innovation. **Navigating both successfully requires integrated policy and packaging design expertise from the outset.**

Eunomia's expertise in legislation, policy, and sustainability informs the commercial and technical realities that Touch uncovers through structural design and consumer-led innovation.

Together, this enables us to turn obligation into opportunity and deliver compliant, technically feasible, and commercially viable packaging solutions faster.

Our integrated approach streamlines workflows, unlocking deeper insights and stronger outcomes. Together, we help FMCG brands create future-proof packaging that meets regulations, engages consumers, and drives circular economy progress.

eunomia

x

touch

Vault is the essential resource for positive packaging innovation: a new, centralized subscription platform to inspire, inform and unlock positive packaging innovation.

VAULT by touch

Packaging savings for major global retailer

26 categories audited

12 countries visited

2437 pack samples analysed

26,300 tonnes of plastic saving opportunities identified

236 unique pack formats rationalised to just 30

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The Brief & Background

A major global retailer set out to reduce the environmental impact of its packaging, with a clear focus on cutting plastic across its own-brand range.

Early assessment revealed a key challenge. Packaging specifications were inconsistent and lacked clarity across the portfolio. To address this, 26 products spanning multiple categories were selected for deep analysis.

The objective was ambitious.
To evaluate these products alongside their competitors across 12 international markets and uncover tangible opportunities to reduce plastic through smarter design, greater harmonisation, and tighter specifications.

Beyond material reduction.
Future packaging needed to work harder across the system. Solutions had to reflect supplier capabilities in each market, respond to competitive and adjacent category benchmarks, meet evolving sustainability metrics, and enhance the consumer experience, all while staying true to the client's distinct design DNA.

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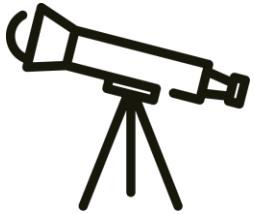
Approach overview

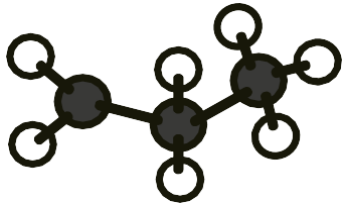
1. align

Kick off session to understand the challenge align on the brief and determine key stakeholders.



2. explore

Collect and gather samples, run analysis of samples and conduct supplier reviews.



3. connect

Detail and quantify opportunities for efficiencies through plastic savings per product in scope

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Sample collection - overview

Teams visited each market, photographed the category, purchased sample products and conducted portion of analysis in market before shipping sample pack back to UK for detailed analysis.

26
Categories

2437
Samples collected

50
Supermarkets

12
Locations

Australia **Austria** **Germany** **Hungary** **Ireland** **Italy** **Slovenia** **Switzerland** **UK** **USA**

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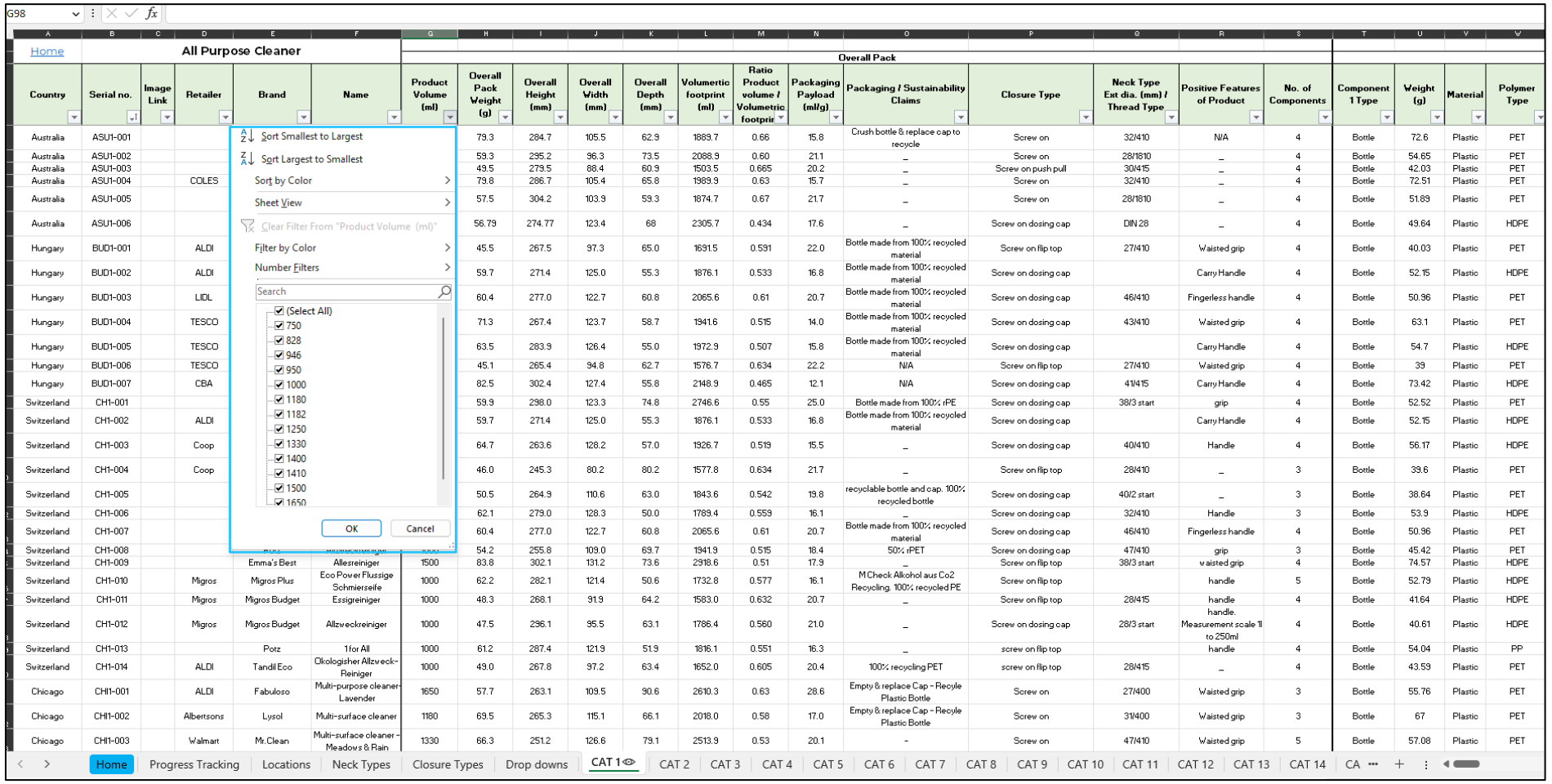
Sample database created



Home | All Purpose Cleaner

Country	Serial no.	Image Link	Retailer	Brand	Name	Product Volume (ml)	Overall Pack Weight (g)	Overall Height (mm)	Overall Width (mm)	Overall Depth (mm)	Volumetric footprint (ml)	Ratio Product volume / Volumetric footprint	Packaging Payload (ml/g)	Packaging / Sustainability Claims	Closure Type	Neck Type Ext dia. (mm) / Thread Type	Positive Features of Product	No. of Components	Component 1 Type	Weight (g)	Material	Polymer Type
							Overall Pack															
Australia	ASU1-001						79.3	284.7	105.5	62.9	1889.7	0.66	15.8	Crush bottle & replace cap to recycle	Screw on	32/410	N/A	4	Bottle	72.6	Plastic	PET
Australia	ASU1-002						59.3	295.2	96.3	73.5	2088.9	0.60	21.1	_	Screw on	28/1610	_	4	Bottle	54.65	Plastic	PET
Australia	ASU1-003						49.5	279.5	88.4	60.9	1503.5	0.665	20.2	_	Screw on push pull	30/415	_	4	Bottle	42.03	Plastic	PET
Australia	ASU1-004		COLES				79.8	286.7	105.4	65.8	1989.9	0.63	15.7	_	Screw on	32/410	_	4	Bottle	72.51	Plastic	PET
Australia	ASU1-005						57.5	304.2	103.9	59.3	1874.7	0.67	21.7	_	Screw on	28/1610	_	4	Bottle	51.89	Plastic	PET
Australia	ASU1-006						56.79	274.77	123.4	68	2305.7	0.434	17.6	_	Screw on dosing cap	DIN 28	_	4	Bottle	49.64	Plastic	HDPE
Hungary	BUD1-001		ALDI				45.5	267.5	97.3	65.0	1691.5	0.591	22.0	Bottle made from 100% recycled material	Screw on flip top	27/410	Waisted grip	4	Bottle	40.03	Plastic	PET
Hungary	BUD1-002		ALDI				59.7	271.4	125.0	55.3	1876.1	0.533	16.8	Bottle made from 100% recycled material	Screw on dosing cap		Carry Handle	4	Bottle	52.15	Plastic	HDPE
Hungary	BUD1-003		LIDL				60.4	277.0	122.7	60.8	2065.6	0.61	20.7	Bottle made from 100% recycled material	Screw on dosing cap	46/410	Fingerless handle	4	Bottle	50.96	Plastic	PET
Hungary	BUD1-004		TESCO				71.3	267.4	123.7	58.7	1941.6	0.515	14.0	Bottle made from 100% recycled material	Screw on dosing cap	43/410	Waisted grip	4	Bottle	63.1	Plastic	PET
Hungary	BUD1-005		TESCO				63.5	283.9	126.4	55.0	1972.9	0.507	15.8	Bottle made from 100% recycled material	Screw on dosing cap		Carry Handle	4	Bottle	54.7	Plastic	HDPE
Hungary	BUD1-006		TESCO				45.1	265.4	94.8	62.7	1576.7	0.634	22.2	N/A	Screw on flip top	27/410	Waisted grip	4	Bottle	39	Plastic	PET
Hungary	BUD1-007		CBA				82.5	302.4	127.4	55.8	2148.9	0.465	12.1	N/A	Screw on dosing cap	41/415	Carry Handle	4	Bottle	73.42	Plastic	HDPE
Switzerland	CH1-001						59.9	298.0	123.3	74.8	2746.6	0.55	25.0	Bottle made from 100% rPE	Screw on dosing cap	38/3 start	grip	4	Bottle	52.52	Plastic	PET
Switzerland	CH1-002		ALDI				59.7	271.4	125.0	55.3	1876.1	0.533	16.8	Bottle made from 100% recycled material	Screw on dosing cap		Carry Handle	4	Bottle	52.15	Plastic	HDPE
Switzerland	CH1-003		Coop				64.7	263.6	128.2	57.0	1926.7	0.519	15.5	_	Screw on dosing cap	40/410	Handle	4	Bottle	56.17	Plastic	HDPE
Switzerland	CH1-004		Coop				46.0	245.3	80.2	80.2	1577.8	0.634	21.7	_	Screw on flip top	28/410	_	3	Bottle	39.6	Plastic	PET
Switzerland	CH1-005						50.5	264.9	110.6	63.0	1843.6	0.542	19.8	recyclable bottle and cap. 100% recycled bottle	Screw on dosing cap	40/2 start	_	3	Bottle	38.64	Plastic	PET
Switzerland	CH1-006						62.1	279.0	128.3	50.0	1789.4	0.559	16.1	_	Screw on dosing cap	32/410	Handle	3	Bottle	53.9	Plastic	HDPE
Switzerland	CH1-007						60.4	277.0	122.7	60.8	2065.6	0.61	20.7	Bottle made from 100% recycled material	Screw on dosing cap	46/410	Fingerless handle	4	Bottle	50.96	Plastic	PET
Switzerland	CH1-008						54.2	255.8	109.0	69.7	1941.9	0.515	18.4	50% rPET	Screw on dosing cap	47/410	grip	3	Bottle	45.42	Plastic	PET
Switzerland	CH1-009			Emma's Best	Allesreiniger	1500	83.8	302.1	131.2	73.6	2918.6	0.51	17.9	_	Screw on flip top	38/3 start	waisted grip	4	Bottle	74.57	Plastic	HDPE
Switzerland	CH1-010		Migros	Migros Plus	Eco Power Flussige Schmierseife	1000	62.2	282.1	121.4	50.6	1732.8	0.577	16.1	M Check Alkohol aus Co2 Recycling. 100% recycled PE	Screw on flip top		handle	5	Bottle	52.79	Plastic	HDPE
Switzerland	CH1-011		Migros	Migros Budget	Essigreiniger	1000	48.3	268.1	91.9	64.2	1583.0	0.632	20.7	_	Screw on flip top	28/415	handle	4	Bottle	41.64	Plastic	HDPE
Switzerland	CH1-012		Migros	Migros Budget	Allzweckreiniger	1000	47.5	296.1	95.5	63.1	1786.4	0.560	21.0	_	Screw on dosing cap	28/3 start	handle. Measurement scale 1l to 250ml	4	Bottle	40.61	Plastic	HDPE
Switzerland	CH1-013			Potz	1for All	1000	61.2	287.4	121.9	51.9	1816.1	0.551	16.3	_	screw on flip top		handle	4	Bottle	54.04	Plastic	PP
Switzerland	CH1-014		ALDI	Tandil Eco	Okologisher Allzweck-Reiniger	1000	49.0	267.8	97.2	63.4	1652.0	0.605	20.4	100% recycling PET	screw on flip top	28/415	_	4	Bottle	43.59	Plastic	PET
Chicago	CHI1-001		ALDI	Fabuloso	Multi-purpose cleaner-Lavender	1650	57.7	263.1	109.5	90.6	2610.3	0.63	28.6	Empty & replace Cap - Recyle Plastic Bottle	Screw on	27/400	Waisted grip	3	Bottle	55.76	Plastic	PET
Chicago	CHI1-002		Albertsons	Lysol	Multi-surface cleaner	1180	69.5	265.3	115.1	66.1	2018.0	0.58	17.0	Empty & replace Cap - Recyle Plastic Bottle	Screw on	31/400	Waisted grip	3	Bottle	67	Plastic	PET
Chicago	CHI1-003		Walmart	Mr.Clean	Multi-surface cleaner - Meadows & Rain	1330	66.3	251.2	126.6	79.1	2513.9	0.53	20.1	-	Screw on	47/410	Waisted grip	5	Bottle	57.08	Plastic	PET

Sort Smallest to Largest
Sort Largest to Smallest
Sort by Color
Sheet View
Clear Filter From "Product Volume (ml)"
Filter by Color
Number Filters
Search
(Select All)
750
828
946
950
1000
1180
1182
1250
1330
1400
1410
1500
1650
OK
Cancel

Home | Progress Tracking | Locations | Neck Types | Closure Types | Drop downs | CAT 1 | CAT 2 | CAT 3 | CAT 4 | CAT 5 | CAT 6 | CAT 7 | CAT 8 | CAT 9 | CAT 10 | CAT 11 | CAT 12 | CAT 13 | CAT 14 | CA

Data collected per sample

- Number of components
- Plastic weights
- Sustainability claims
- Levels of PCR used
- Top load strength
- Pack dimensions
- Volumetric ratio
- Polymer types
- Category specific info e.g.
    - Thread types
    - Closure types
    - Seal types
    - Dispenser types

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Example product audit – all-purpose cleaner

sensitive information redacted

Included products: All-purpose cleaner vinegar, Eco cleaner vinegar

Target size: 1000ml

Target material: PET

Sales volume: XX

Own brand examples

Code: SZG-001
Overall weight: xxx

Code: DUS1-006
Overall weight: xxx

Code: BUD1-001
Overall weight: xxx

Code: SVN1-001
Overall weight: xxx

Code: UK1-001
Overall weight: xxx

89
Samples collected

21
Supermarkets

12
Locations

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#1 All-purpose cleaner – sample overview

xx-xxg
Weight range
Overall packaging weight

750-1650ml
Product fill

2-5
No. components

1.7-20.5%
Headspace

90-576N
Top load

1252-3024ml
Volumetric footprint

0-100%
Recycled content

12.1-28.6g/ml
Material usage per product fill

Category Example

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#1 All-purpose cleaner – Opportunity

1. Packaging weight

Reduce client's overall pack weight by:
8.7 – 33.7g

Potential material saving:
19.4 – 48%

Potential material saving/year
54 – 209 tonnes

2. Pack volumetric format optimisation

- Honing the pack to be volumetrically efficient for the best packaging payload
- Optimising pallet efficiency for best pallet load

See example section

3. Harmonisation

- Harmonising structures in globally **5 into 1**
- Harmonising structures in key regions **3 into 1**
- Opportunity to harmonise most efficient production method, material and format
- Opportunity to harmonise cap and label formats

4. Cross category harmonisation

- Potential to explore harmonisation of structure across categories such as:
  - Rinse aid
  - Laundry care

5. Increase recycled content

- 100% recycled content for bottle and closure

6. Branding opportunity

- Create a design that further plays to the benchmark brand cues

7. Product/Pack innovation opportunity

- Explore concentrated product fill solutions for smaller volumetric footprint and/or increased payload
- Consider low environmental impact product fill. No micro plastics etc.

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The Result

- In just 4 months the team uncovered a wealth of opportunities for efficiency and plastic reduction across all categories audited.

- 26 categories audited

- 12 countries visited

- 2437 pack samples analyzed

- 26,300 tonnes of plastic savings opportunities identified

- Opportunity to reduce 236 unique pack formats to 30

- The opportunities identified have resulted in a number
- of internal and supplier workstreams.

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Thank You

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About Eunomia

Eunomia is an independent sustainability consultancy driven by a genuine passion to make a positive change to the clients we work with and the communities they operate in. Founded in 2001, we have been pioneers in the sector - early advocates for helping NGOs as well as leading public and private sector organisations in the UK and overseas to adapt their approach and adopt more sustainable processes.

Our consultants are experts in the field, deeply immersed in the subject with the technical knowledge and skill to offer clients innovative, clear and practical recommendations. We are committed to finding solutions to better protect the planet, while supporting the wider aims and needs of our clients.

Each client is treated as an individual, with consultants taking the time to understand their objectives and how best we can support them. This personal service ensures a strong relationship is forged, based on honest and regular communication. It also ensures if these objectives change, there is the flexibility to adapt.

As an established leading independent consultancy, clients can have complete confidence that consultants will offer evidence-led solutions based on robust, impartial thinking that offer both pragmatic and positive outcomes.